

PREMISE DELTA v0.5 (THE TRUSTING FORGERY, THIRD CUT): FABLE ATTACK ·

2026-09-11

Fresh Fable agent, given only four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.5-2026-09-09.md and its own six-front prompt; told to attack the answers in sections 8 and 9. Filed verbatim. GPT's independent attack on the same text goes beside it when Stephen runs it; the disposition follows; Stephen rules. Verdict: REWORK, high confidence; "the device itself ... I could not break on its own terms"; the driver is Margo's Day 19 list.

Adversarial review of Premise delta v0.5, third cut. Second reviewer. I have read sections 1 to 11 and nothing else, and I take sections 8 and 9 as the whole record of what has been asked and answered.

Front 1. Margo, un-engaged

Objection. The next question is asked by the same accountant on the same call, Day 45, and it is the question any accountant asks when another accountant says "in the books": and outside them? He rang because the café told him Violet was calling money in. Calling in has a debtor. Either the café gave him a name or he asks the café for one; both are one step. "Nothing in the books" is a qualifier, and to a professional a qualifier is an invitation. Her answer then has to be one of two things: "Brad owed her the van money on no paper and she was calling it in," or a lie. Section 5 says she answers "truthfully and narrowly." A narrow truth lives for exactly one question. If she names Brad, the administrator writes to Brad for a debt to the estate within the week, and the sister, who was told by Margo herself on Day 8 that a debt book was missing from a locked house, now holds a missing record of a debt, a named debtor, and a man's back in the lane; her Day 46 call is to Del, not to Margo. If Margo lies, the document has to own that she lied to the estate's professional about money owed to the estate, and "an omission is not evidence" no longer describes her. A lie is a different woman and a different lock.

The deeper failure is that section 5 calls Day 45 "the arrival" and nothing arrives. Section 3 states that Margo "holds the debt and the calling-in" before Day 14; that is how the pooled true letter would name Brad. Section 5 has her notice on Day 8 that the debt book, which only she knew existed, was gone from a locked house where Violet died with two glasses out. Section 3 has the forgery keep Violet's instruction verbatim: each of you write down everything odd you've noticed this year, about each other and about me, and read the four lists at one table. Meeting 1 is Day 19. The list a competent accountant writes on Day 19, obeying a dead friend's instruction in her own hand, contains: Vi lent Brad the van money on no paper, was calling it in this autumn for the fight with her sister, and the book she kept it in is gone. The document gives her no reason to withhold it. "Violet's confidence" fails because the confidence is released by the confider, in her hand, on the same page. "An omission is not evidence" fails because the table is not a court and the instruction is for odd things, not for evidence. The accountant's call on Day 45 adds no fact she did not hold on the night of Day 14; it adds a prompt. So the six weeks from Day 14 to Day 54 rest on Margo declining, on Days 19, 26, 33, 40 and 47, to write the one odd thing she holds, while she underlines Spring against Liam.

Severity. Fatal to the room as drawn.

What would have to be true. Either Margo does not know the debtor's name before Day 45, in which case section 3 must change and Day 45 needs a path to Brad's name that is not the café (if it is the café, the sister has it too); or Margo has a reason, written on the page, that survives a written instruction to pool; or the Day 45 call is not a debt question at all. Separately, the second question on the Day 45 call has to be answered in her voice, on the page, with its cost named.

Front 2. The room's closed pool

Objection. The sentence closes the wrong pool. "Only you four know where the spare lives" is Violet's sentence about the autumn: the tin, the roof, the shelf. The room uses it to close the night. The night needs no key. Two glasses mean she opened her front door to someone and poured; a back door that latches means he left without one; the document's own Day 0 has Brad come in as a guest and go out through a latch. Liam, who found her and reported front locked, back latched, spare in place, is the man who did every repair in that house and knows a latched door latches itself, and the document lets the room draw the key inference in front of him without his saying so. The competent person who refuses is Ruby, whom the document has already written as the one who hears the police line as not-Vi and who says "she thought she'd know, and she's dead." A Ruby who hears those cannot fail to hear that Monday's visitor was let in. Once said, the pool for Monday is everyone Violet would pour for at ten at night, and a one-evening audit of "her whole week" is not that pool.

The outsider the audit misses is at the café, where Violet carried the panel and where, by Day 45 for a stranger's accountant and at ten months for Ally, it is known that she spent the autumn calling money in. The four never ask there. And the audit of a locked store with a letter in it never asks the sheds who approached that door in the fortnight, though the sheds are worked from first light and the witness the document needs for chapter 4 was standing in them. Section 5, Day 15, audits the house. The letter came from the store.

Severity. Serious. Fatal in combination with Front 6 if Ruby, driving from Day 40 and suspecting one of the four, ever asks the sheds; nothing on the page stops her.

What would have to be true. Ruby and Liam are given, on the page, the reason they let a sentence about the autumn close the night when the two glasses in front of them say the door was opened; the café's knowledge of the calling-in is shown to be unavailable to the four on Day 15 though available to an outsider's accountant on Day 45; and the room is shown never to ask the sheds, with a reason.

Front 3. Violet shows Brad

Objection. The answer to finding 6 puts the panel in front of four people outside the four before Violet dies, and each of them now holds: Violet had a panel in her own hand that she said she did not make, and she was frightened enough to carry it round the trade. That is a pre-death witness to a forger of her hand, held by the café and two signwriters. The document's day-after for Violet is to stop asking. A competent Violet, the best judge of a hand on the coast and by the document's own facts the only gilder in it (the leaf at the yard was always hers; she never taught Brad leaf), has one cheap question left: who else on this coast buys leaf and size. If the answer is a name, she ends the episode before Day 0. If Brad bought by post to his own door, the question dies, and the document has to say so, because at present it stands on Violet not asking it.

Brad's day-after is the acceleration; that is the document's answer and it holds. His keeping the panel is ruled character and I do not re-raise it. What I raise is downstream of the trade: two signwriters who give Ally the panel at ten months were in town when the police looked properly after Day 60. If the proper look reaches the trade, "a panel in her hand that she disowned, now missing from her effects" is not nothing, and row 25 and R27 were ruled before the trade held it.

Which ends it early. Violet, if she asks the supplier and the answer names him. Brad, if she does not.

Severity. Serious.

What would have to be true. Leaf and size have no local source Violet can ask; and the police's proper look is shown never to reach the café or the signwriters, with a reason why two people who volunteer the panel to a podcast did not volunteer it to a detective asking about a death their friends were calling murder.

Front 4. The fourteen days, third time

Objection. The door holds against Brad and against the sheds. It does not hold against the administrator, and the document already concedes she cuts it: Day 82. A person who cuts the lock on Day 82 learned of the store on some earlier day, and the document does not say which day or by what path. If the rent, a year ahead in cash, is in the business books, Margo handed the sister the store's existence on Day 8 along with the books, and an administrator inventorying assets has the store six days before the four do, with her own bolt cropper, every right to use it, and nothing visibly wrong in the act. Behind the door on Day 13 are the true letter (tin, panel, money), her mother's ashes kept from her for four years, and the panel. The episode ends in the sister's hands. "The sheds hold no next of kin" answers the sheds telling her; it does not answer her finding it in her sister's own records. The document needs the rent to be where the loan was, off the books by Violet's choice, and to say so, and then to say how the sister still reached it by Day 82.

The second point engages finding 3's answer directly. "Two hours at her bench" moved the exposed act out of the store and into the dead woman's house. On Day 14, in daylight, thirteen days after she died, Brad lets himself in with the spare from the meter box, works two hours in her workshop, and burns a book, a letter and his drafts in her kitchen sink, under the window of the neighbour who noticed a man's back at half past ten at night. He did not need her bench: he was in that house through the autumn with the spare and again on Day 0, and her paper and pen were his for the taking any time. The only thing her house gives him on Day 14 is a sink, and it is the worst sink on the coast. The man whose method is that nothing is ever visibly wrong does not make smoke in a dead woman's kitchen at noon.

One physical loose end. A new closed-shackle padlock ships with its own keys. "Had four cut and kept none" says nothing about the manufacturer's keys, and the letter's "these four are the only ones" needs her book to record that she destroyed them, or Brad, reading the book on Day 0, learns where they are and the fourteen days are his to shorten.

Severity. Serious on the sister's path (it turns on one fact the document has not stated); serious on the Day 14 house visit; cosmetic on the manufacturer's keys.

What would have to be true. The store's rent is provably outside anything the sister received on Day 8, and the document states how and on what day she came to it for Day 82; the conforming and the burning happen at Brad's own bench, or a reason is given why his own bench will not serve; the book records the fate of the original keys.

Front 5. The two glasses

Objection. The glasses are the author's, not Brad's. He brought a rucksack for a book; he latched a door; he left the one object in the room that carries his skin. Nothing is ever visibly wrong, except two glasses on the side in the house of a woman who lived alone, on the night she died. Take them as the document has them and ask what the police did on Day 1. An unattended death of a forty-four-year-old at the foot of her stairs, two glasses, a visitor not come forward: the attending officer notes company, and the coroner's officer's first question is who. If N^o14 tells a friend at the funeral about a man's back at half past ten, N^o14 tells a constable at the door on Day 1, and the document does not say the police never knocked. So on Day 1 the police either bagged the glasses, in which case the second carries Brad's prints and the proper look after Day 60 takes elimination prints from three survivors accusing each other, finds the fourth set on the missing man's van and locker, and the police close the case on Brad before Ally starts; or they did not bag them, in which case someone washed them between 22:30 on Day 0 and Day 15, and the document has to say who, and whether that person understood what they were rinsing.

The room can use the glasses when the coroner could not only because the room has the letter. But the room is, by the document's own claim, competent, and competent adults know a stranger's glass takes a print; on Day 15 nobody says the word. The vo.3 answer to Ruby-to-Del was that either branch survives. The branch in which Ruby takes a glass to Del does not survive if the glass still exists.

Severity. Serious; fatal if the glasses were bagged.

What would have to be true. Brad has a stated reason to leave two glasses; the fate of the glasses from 22:30 Day 0 to Day 15 is written; N^o14's silence to the police is given a reason; and the room's failure to think of prints is either given a reason or the glass is gone before the room can want it.

Front 6. The whole

Earliest competent action. Margo, Day 8. She notices, from a locked house, the disappearance of a book that only she knew existed, that recorded a cash loan to Brad which Violet was calling in; she knows Violet died with two glasses out; she tells the sister and is shrugged. An accountant shrugged by a lay administrator over a missing record of debts owed to the estate takes it to the administrator's own accountant or to Del. Either puts Brad's name beside the missing record and the man in the lane before the keys arrive. The document's shield for Margo, "Violet's confidence, a book nobody else knew existed, an omission is not evidence," is a shield for silence after Day 14, and Front 1 says why it fails on Day 19; on Day 8 it is thinner still, because on Day 8 nothing is an omission. A record of debts has gone from a dead woman's locked house, and Margo is the only person alive who knows what it recorded and whose name was in it.

If the document holds Day 8 on grief and a shrug, the earliest certain action is Margo's list on Day 19, and the room ends by Day 26. Behind those, in order: the attending officer and the glasses on Day 1 (Front 5); the solicitor on Day 12, who holds four death-triggered letters for an intestate client dead in a fall, asked her why and got a joke, and whose papers now go to the administrator, so that the sister knows by Day 15 that four friends received secret letters and asks them; N^o14 on Day 14 (Front 4); Liam on Day 33, when the room turns on him and the accused man asks the one thing an accused man asks of the friend who priced a van from the crane cab and lied about a wedding in Vi's own hand, where the van money came from, with Margo at the table hearing the answer; and the sheds, asked by anyone on any day from Day 15 (Front 2). There is not none. There are six, and three of them are Margo.

Severity. Fatal.

What would have to be true. Sections 3 and 5 agree on what Margo knows and when. If she knows the debt and the debtor before Day 14, she is given a reason on the page not to write it on Day 19 that survives Violet's own instruction, and a reason on Day 8 not to take a missing record of estate debts past a shrug.

Verdict

REWORK. Confidence high. The single finding that drives it: section 3 has Margo holding the debt and the calling-in before the letter arrives, and has the forgery keep Violet's instruction to write down everything odd about each other and pool it; section 5 then has her write nothing for five meetings and calls a Day 45 phone call, which adds no fact she did not already hold, "the arrival." The room's six weeks stand on a competent accountant declining, five times, to obey her dead friend's hand. The device itself, a forgery of trust that lets four honest people convict Liam out of true things, I could not break on its own terms, and the box number in chapter 7 is now a real suspect turn. What breaks is the timetable around Margo, and behind it two facts the author needs that this killer would not have left: two glasses with his prints on the side, and two hours with a fire in the victim's kitchen on the morning of the reading. Fix Margo's day and state the sister's path to the store; the rest is repair, not rebuild.